



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Education
SOCCSKSARGEN REGION

01 Sept 2026

OFFICE MEMORANDUM
QAD-2026-199

**ADOPTION OF THE SOX PRExCI POLICY FRAMEWORK IN THE QUALITY
MANAGEMENT SYSTEM OF DEPED SOCCSKSARGEN REGIONAL OFFICE**

To: Assistant Regional Director
Functional Division Chiefs
All RO Personnel

1. The Philippine Quality Award (PQA) is the highest level of national recognition for exemplary organizational performance. It is equivalent to the prestigious Malcolm Baldrige National Quality Award (MBNQA) in the U.S and the National Quality Awards nationwide. This was established through Executive Order No. 448, issued by former President Fidel V. Ramos on October 3, 1997, and institutionalized through Republic Act No. 9013, otherwise known as the Philippine Quality Award Act of 2001. Organizations, whether large or small, in the private and public sectors may apply this tool in the quest for organizational excellence and global competitiveness to improve the quality of life for Filipino people.
2. To improve the competitiveness of the country in today's changing environment, a study refinement was proposed to simplify the PQA Award process, providing unprecedented opportunities to all public and private organizations in the regions. A simplification and institutional dispersion will be implemented, creating regional recognition as a qualifying mechanism for national recognition and eventual PQA.
3. DepEd SOCCSKSARGEN Regional Office has expressed its commitment to actively participate in all PQA-related activities, including orientations, capability-building trainings, mentoring and handholding sessions, and regional and national assessments, and to work closely with the assigned PQA Consultants and the Department of Trade and Industry-Bureau of Competitive Development (DTI-BCD) to maximize the benefits of the program.
4. In line with this commitment, this Office implements the **SOX PRExCI Policy Framework** to effectively drive organizational excellence in performance and present a valuable opportunity to strengthen systems, processes, and results by adopting the PQA framework using the ADLI and LeTCI approaches. This signifies the organization's serious dedication to adopting quality and productivity principles.
5. This policy covers the key processes in the Quality Control Plan per functional division, process flow and design, roles and responsibilities of the PQA Core Team, monitoring and evaluation, including the evaluation criteria, scoring guide, and reporting mechanism.
6. Enclosed are the implementing guidelines and the ADLI and LeTCI templates.



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7. Should there be further clarifications, contact the QAD via email qad.region12@deped.gov.ph or through (083) 228-1896.
8. For the information and compliance of all concerned.


ATTY. ALBERTO T. ESCOBARTE, CESO II
Regional Director

MAP/QAD/OM-ADOPTION OF SOX PREXCI FRAMEWORK IN THE QUALITY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM OF DEPED
SOCCSKSARGEN
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**IMPLEMENTING GUIDELINES ON THE ADOPTION OF THE SOX PRExCI
POLICY FRAMEWORK IN THE QUALITY MANAGEMENT
SYSTEM OF DEPED SOCCSKSARGEN**

I. RATIONALE

1. Republic Act No. 9013, also known as the **Philippine Quality Award (PQA) Act**, is the country's highest national recognition for exemplary organizational performance. It was enacted to encourage public and private organizations to achieve world-class excellence in quality management, products, and service delivery. This legislation provides a more detailed framework for the award's operation, including its criteria, application process, and recognition standards, after it was established through Executive Order No. 448, issued by former President Fidel V. Ramos on October 3, 1997, as the initial legal foundation for the award's creation and implementation.
2. This national recognition is patterned after the U.S. Malcolm Baldrige National Quality Award, helping both private and public organizations assess performance and build a culture of continuous improvement. The framework utilizes a 1,000-point scoring system based on seven core criteria: leadership, strategy, customer, measurement, analysis and knowledge management, workforce, operations, and results. Organizations are evaluated on a progressive scale and can be recognized in four tiers: Level 1 – Commitment to Quality Management; Level 2 – Proficiency in Quality Management; Level 3 – Mastery in Quality Management; and Level 4 – Philippine Quality Award for Performance Excellence.
3. DepEd SOCCSKSARGEN Regional Office has long been committed to strengthening its quality management systems, having achieved ISO 9001:2015 certification as a foundation for organizational excellence. Building on this achievement, the region is seeking the Philippine Quality Award (PQA) Level 2. This aspiration follows the conferment of **PQA Level 1** (Recognition for Commitment to Quality Management), signifying the organization's serious dedication to adopting quality and productivity principles.
4. Further, this Office has expressed its commitment to actively participate in all PQA-related activities, including orientations, capability-building trainings, mentoring and handholding sessions, and regional and national assessments, and work closely with the assigned PQA Consultants and the Department of Trade and Industry-Bureau of Competitive Development (DTI-BCD) to maximize the benefits of the program. More importantly, this commitment drives organizational excellence in performance and presents a valuable opportunity to strengthen systems, processes, and results.

II. OBJECTIVES

The SOX PRExCI Framework aims to:



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- **Adopt** the PQA standards by integrating the ADLI (Approach–Deployment–Learning–Integration) for process evaluation and LeTCI (Levels–Trends–Comparisons–Integration) for results evaluation of key processes, harmonized with ISO 9001:2015 requirements.
- **Conduct** coaching and mentoring, capacity-building workshops, and guided application sessions for Functional Divisions and Quality Management System (QMS) Teams to enhance their competencies in applying the framework.
- **Establish** systematic and data-driven approaches to evaluating organizational performance, ensuring accountability and transparency among all functional divisions.
- **Support** RBEDP priorities on organizational excellence, continuous improvement, and stakeholder confidence by embedding the SOX PRExCI framework into functional division key processes.

III. DEFINITION OF TERMS

To ensure consistent interpretation of these implementing guidelines, the core terms are defined below according to the Philippine Quality Award **SOX PRExCI** framework:

- ADLI-** The four-dimensional evaluation mechanism (Approach-Deployment-Learning-Integration) used to assess organizational process items in terms of how systematically processes are planned, consistently executed across units, continuously refined through improvement cycles, and aligned with organizational goals.
- Customers-** The primary internal and external stakeholders receiving the services of DepEd SOCCSKSARGEN. It consists explicitly of those listed in the agency's Relevant Interested Parties directory.
- LeTCI-** The holistic evaluation mechanism (Levels, Trends, Comparisons, and Integration) used to score organizational results items in terms of overall performance through numerical metrics, progress over time, external benchmarking, and link to operational goals.
- Leadership-** This is one of the seven performance excellence categories used for assessment and four award levels of recognition in the Philippine Quality Award. This assesses the senior management behaviors, organizational governance, and societal responsibilities. Its focus is on how leaders set vision, values, legal compliance, and performance expectations.
- Measurement, Analysis, & Knowledge Management-** This is one of the seven performance excellence categories used for assessment and four award levels of recognition in the Philippine Quality Award. This focuses The organizational system for handling data, performance tracking, and digital assets. It reviews data integrity, information availability, and the systematic analysis of performance metrics.
- Operations-** This is one of the seven performance excellence categories used for assessment and four award levels of recognition in the Philippine Quality Award with focus on the design, management, and continuous improvement of work systems and processes. Further, it encompasses management, core, support, and outsourced workflows to deliver efficient customer value.



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- PQA Level-** The official four-tier national recognition status awarded for organizational performance excellence. It is evaluated on a standard 1,000-point scoring system with tiers: Level 1 (Commitment), Level 2 (Proficiency), Level 3 (Mastery), and Level 4 (PQA for Performance Excellence).
- Process-** The linked, structured, and repeatable organizational methods used to achieve performance excellence. It is evaluated continuously through the systematic application of the ADLI methodology.
- Results-** The outputs, outcomes, and numeric evidence demonstrating overall organizational performance. It is evaluated systematically across multiple performance dimensions using the LeTCI framework.
- SOX PRExCI-** The localized performance excellence framework used by DepEd SOCCSKSARGEN used to contextualize national Philippine Quality Award (PQA) criteria into regional basic education operations.
- Strategy-** This is one of the seven performance excellence categories used for assessment and four award levels of recognition in the Philippine Quality Award. This category considers the structured planning process for developing, aligning, and deploying organizational goals. The focus is on the strategic objectives, resource allocation, action plans, and future operational risk resilience.
- Workforce-** This is one of the seven performance excellence categories used for assessment and four award levels of recognition in the Philippine Quality Award. The human resource element comprises all personnel within the regional office. It reviews approaches to developing, engaging, empowering, and maintaining the well-being of employees.



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IV. THE SOX PRExCI FRAMEWORK

The SOX PRExCI Framework serves as the strategic roadmap for DepEd SOCCSKSARGEN to systematically transition its Quality Management System (QMS) from compliance to performance excellence.

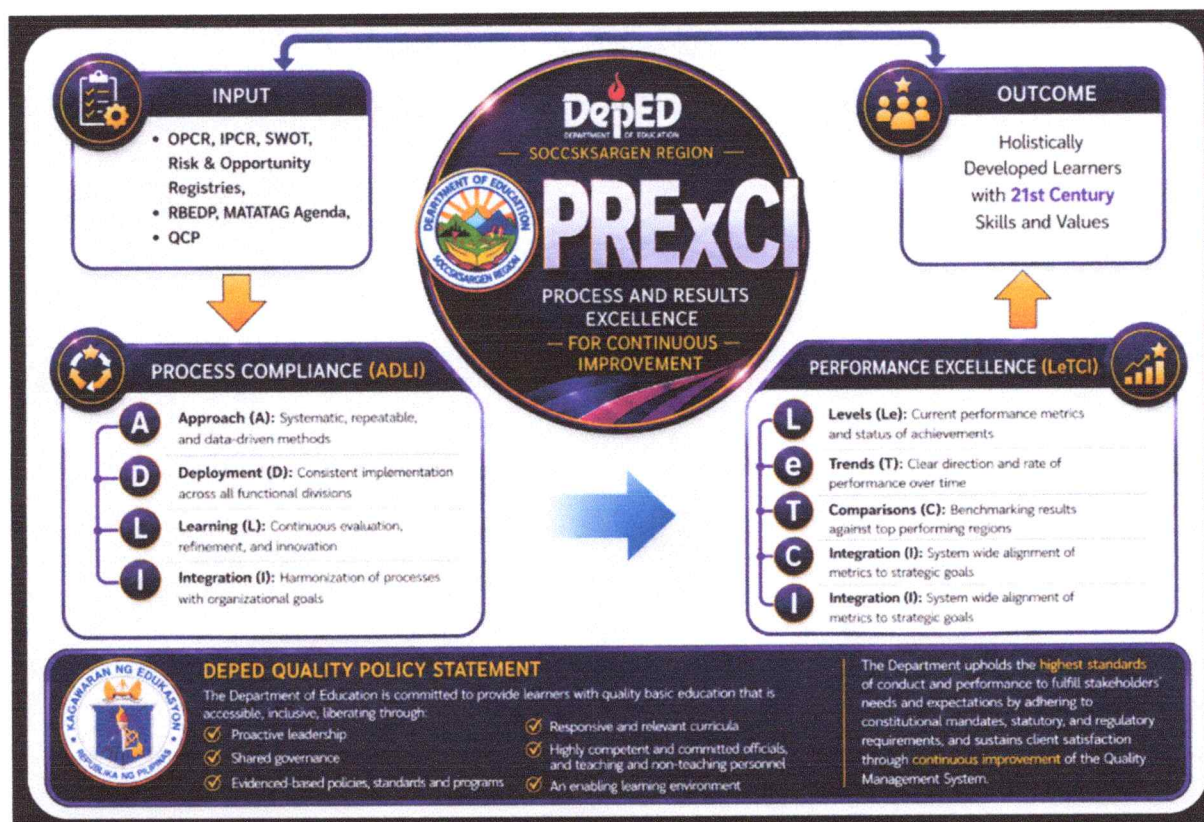


Figure 1: SOX PRExCI Framework

V. THE PQA CORE TEAM

PQA Core Team Composition, Roles, and Responsibilities

To ensure the effective adoption of the SOX PRExCI Framework and the systematic completion of the PQA Self-Assessment Tool for Excellence Package (PQA-STEP), the DepEd SOCCSKSARGEN PQA Core Team is hereby established with the following designated roles and responsibilities:

PQA Core Team Designation

PQAR Focal

Roles and Responsibilities

- Facilitates capacity-building activities and consensus meetings.
- Ensures on-time submission of requirements by category.
- Coordinates accomplished outputs with the PQA Consultant / regional focal.



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Head, Secretariat	• Manages the “PQA hour” schedule and communicates targets. • Tracks outputs per category requirements. • Ensures organized outputs for final submission.
Secretariat Members	• Assist the Head Secretariat in managing timelines and tracking outputs. • Maintain the central repository of all category documents. • Consolidate and quality-assure submitted files for organizational layout.
Category 1 (Leadership) • Team Leader • Deputy • Member	• Accomplishes the PQA-STEP under Category 1 (Leadership). • Prepares the necessary Means of Verification (MOVs) supporting self-assessment results. • Documents systemic leadership, governance, and societal contribution mechanisms.
Category 2 (Strategy) • Team Leader • Deputy • Member	• Accomplishes the PQA-STEP under Category 2 (Strategy). • Prepares the necessary Means of Verification (MOVs) supporting self-assessment results.
Category 3 (Customers) • Team Leader • Deputy • Member	• Accomplishes the PQA-STEP under Category 3 (Customers). • Prepares the necessary Means of Verification (MOVs) supporting self-assessment results.
Category 4 (Measurement, Analysis, & Knowledge Management) • Team Leader • Deputy • Member	• Accomplishes the PQA-STEP under Category 4 (Measurement, Analysis, & KM). • Prepares the necessary Means of Verification (MOVs) supporting self-assessment results.
Category 5 (Workforce) • Team Leader • Deputy • Member	• Accomplishes the PQA-STEP under Category 5 (Workforce). • Prepares the necessary Means of Verification (MOVs) supporting self-assessment results.
Category 6 (Operations) • Team Leader • Deputy • Members (2 Pax)	• Accomplishes the PQA-STEP under Category 6 (Operations). • Prepares the necessary Means of Verification (MOVs) supporting self-assessment results.



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Category 7 (Product/Service & Process Results)

- Team Leader
- Deputy
- Member

- Accomplishes the PQA-STEP under Category 7 (Results).
- Prepares the necessary Means of Verification (MOVs) supporting self-assessment results.

VI. PROCESS FLOW DESIGN

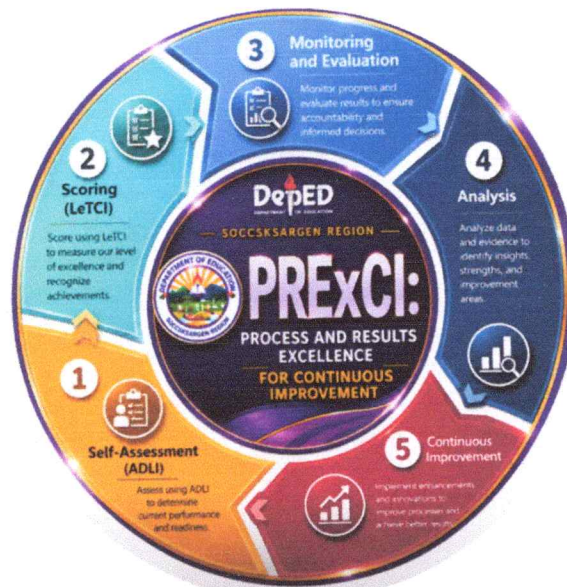


Figure 2: SOX PRExCI Process Design

VII. PROCESS STEPS

No.	STEP	TASK	PERSON RESPONSIBLE	OUTPUTS	TIMELINE
1	Self-Assessment	1. Identify key processes per functional division. 2. Present the Quality Control Plan per process. 3. Determine current performance and readiness for improvement of each process	Functional Division	Quality Control Plan per identified process Self-assessment results using the ADLI matrix. MOVs for each process.	January-March



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		using the ADLI approach. 4. Provide necessary and relevant supporting documents.			
2	Scoring	1. Provide 5-year-back results data. 2. Measure level of excellence using the contextualized LeTCI. 3. Provide a graphical presentation of the results per process.	Functional Division	Graphical presentation of results	April-June
3	Monitoring and Evaluation	1. Monitor progress and evaluate results quarterly from ADLI and LeTCI	PQA Team	Quarterly M & E Report	July-August
4	Analysis	1. Analyze data and evidence to identify insights and improvement areas per process quarterly.	Functional Division Chiefs	Quarterly Data Analysis Report	September-October
5	Continuous Improvement	1. Implement process enhancements and innovation to improve processes and achieve better results	Functional Division	Innovation	November-December

VIII. MONITORING AND EVALUATION

The Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Mechanism ensures that all functional divisions systematically monitor process performance, evaluate organizational excellence using the ADLI (Approach–Deployment–Learning–Integration) and LeTCI



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(Levels–Trends–Comparisons–Integration) frameworks, and implement timely improvements to achieve continuous organizational excellence.

This monitoring and evaluation mechanism also supports the SOX PRExCI Framework by establishing a structured, evidence-based system for tracking performance, validating results, and driving continuous organizational improvement through the ADLI, LeTCI, and Plan–Do–Check–Act (PDCA) approaches.

Below is the SOX PRExCI M&E Cycle:

1. SOX PRExCI Monitoring and Evaluation Cycle

The figure below shows the M&E Cycle of the SOX PRExCI Framework.



Figure 3: SOX PRExCI Monitoring and Evaluation Cycle



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2. Monitoring Mechanism

Activity	Frequency	Responsible Office	Output
Process Self-Assessment (ADLI)	<i>Annually</i>	Functional Divisions	ADLI Assessment Report
LeTCI Results Assessment	<i>Annually</i>	Functional Divisions	Results Scorecard
Progress Monitoring	<i>Quarterly</i>	PRExCI Core Team	Monitoring Report
Validation of Evidence	<i>Quarterly</i>	QA Team	Validation Checklist
Performance Review Meeting	<i>Quarterly</i>	Management Review	Minutes of Meeting
Technical Assistance	<i>As Needed</i>	FTAD/QAD	Technical Assistance Report
Improvement Action Monitoring	<i>Quarterly</i>	Process Owners	Action Plan Status
Annual Performance Review	<i>Year-end</i>	QAD	Organizational Performance Report

3. Evaluation Criteria

Process Evaluation (ADLI)

The following criteria shall be assessed:

- *Approach*
 - Systematic
 - Effective
 - Responsive
- *Deployment*
 - Implemented consistently
 - Applied across offices
 - Documented
- *Learning*
 - Best practices identified
 - Lessons learned documented
 - Innovation introduced
- *Integration*
 - Aligned with organizational goals
 - Embedded in management systems
 - Sustained implementation



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4. Results Evaluation (LeTCI)

LeTCI Performance Indicators

Levels (Le)

- Current performance
- Target attainment
- Performance status

Trends (T)

- Five-year performance trend
- Sustained improvement
- Rate of improvement

Comparisons I

- Internal comparison
- Regional benchmarking
- National benchmarking

Integration (I)

- Alignment with strategic objectives
- Organizational impact
- Support for evidence-based decision-making
- Contribution to continuous improvement
- *Levels*

- Current performance

- *Trends*

- Five-year performance trend

- *Comparisons*

- Internal
- Regional
- National benchmarking

- *Integration*

- Alignment with strategic objectives
- Organizational impact

5. Results Evaluation Criteria (LeTCI)

Performance results shall be evaluated using the LeTCI dimensions to determine the level of organizational excellence.

Dimension	Criteria	Key Questions	Evidence
L – Levels	Assess current performance against established targets and standards.	• Are performance targets achieved? • What is the current level of performance? • Are results acceptable or excellent?	Performance indicators, accomplishment reports, scorecards, dashboards



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Dimension	Criteria	Key Questions	Evidence
T – Trends	Examine performance over the last five (5) years to determine improvement, stability, or decline.	• Is performance improving over time? • Are gains sustained? • Are negative trends addressed? • How do results compare with previous years?	Five-year trend graphs, annual reports, statistical analysis
	Compare results with internal benchmarks and external standards.	• How do they compare with regional and national benchmarks? • Are best practices achieved? • Are results aligned with strategic objectives?	Internal comparisons, regional rankings, national benchmark data
I – Integration	Evaluate how results support organizational goals and strategic priorities.	• Do results demonstrate organizational impact? • Do results support continuous improvement and decision-making?	Strategic plans, OPCR/IPCR, Quality Objectives, Management Review

6. Scoring Guide

Rating	Description
5 – Excellent	Outstanding results with sustained improvement, superior benchmarks, and full strategic alignment.
4 – Very Good	Strong results, positive trends, and good alignment with organizational objectives.
3 – Good	Acceptable performance with evidence of improvement and partial benchmarking.
2 – Developing	Results are inconsistent with limited trend data and weak integration.
1 – Beginning	Results are minimal or unavailable, with no evidence of sustained improvement or alignment.



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Note: This mirrors the ADLI process evaluation and makes LeTCI a complementary framework for evaluating results for the SOX PRExCI model.

7. Monitoring Indicators

ADLI Process Indicators

- Percentage of documented key processes
- ADLI Assessment Score
- Percentage of deployed process improvements
- Percentage of completed action plans

LeTCI Results Indicators

- LeTCI Score
- Process Efficiency Rate
- Stakeholder Satisfaction
- Compliance Rate
- Target Accomplishment
- Innovation Index

Data Sources

- Quality Control Plans
- ADLI
- LeTCI
- Quarterly Accomplishment Reports
- Performance Scorecards
- Monitoring Checklists
- Client Satisfaction Survey Results
- Internal Audit Reports
- ISO/QMS Reports

8. Semestral Monitoring Matrix

Semester	Activity	Tool	Output
1st	Baseline Monitoring, Mid-Year Review	ADLI Matrix, LeTCI Matrix	Monitoring/Progress Report
2nd	Performance Validation, Annual Evaluation	ADLI Matrix, LeTCI Matrix	Validation Report, Annual PRExCI Report



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9. Reporting Process

The figure below shows the reporting process, which forms part of the monitoring and evaluation.



Figure 4: Reporting Process

10. Feedback Mechanism

Monitoring results shall be discussed during:

- Quarterly Performance Review
- Management Review Meetings
- Learning Action Sessions
- Technical Assistance Conferences
- Strategic Planning Workshops

The feedback generated shall be translated into specific improvement actions.



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11. Continuous Improvement Mechanism (PDCA)

The figure below illustrates the steps to ensure continuous improvement of this policy.

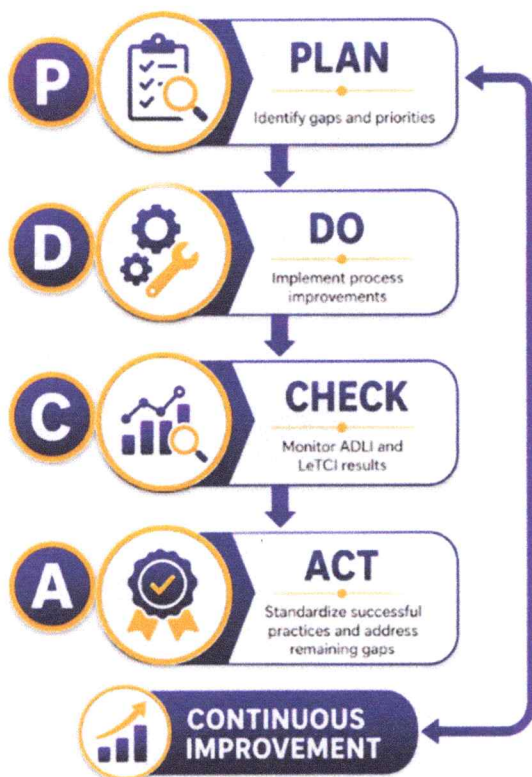


Figure 5: Continuous Improvement Mechanism (PDCA)

Enclosure 1: ADLI Template

Process:			
Sub-Process			
Key Performance Indicators: 1. 2. 3.			
Evaluation	STRENGTH	OPPORTUNITY	EVIDENCE
Approach			
Deployment			
Learning			
Integration			



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Enclosure 2: LeTCI Template

Process:					
Sub-Process					
Key Performance Indicators	LEVEL	TREND	COMPARISON	INTEGRATION	EVIDENCE